

The Haverford Math Department Presents

# Puzzle Week 2026

Monday, May 18 - Tuesday, May 26, 2026

- This packet contains 7 puzzles. The first 6 puzzles are independent of one another. The final puzzle is a metapuzzle: it requires the answers from the other 6 puzzles in order to solve it.
- The answer to each puzzle is a single word, name, or short phrase in English.
- You may use the internet and any other resources at your disposal.
- The puzzles are designed to be collaborative. Work alone or form a team of 2 - 5 friends, colleagues, classmates, teachers, etc. to solve the puzzles. Do NOT share answers with other teams.
- Each participant (whether working solo or on a team) should register at [puzzleweek.abrastat.com](https://puzzleweek.abrastat.com).
- Submit your answers at [puzzleweek.abrastat.com](https://puzzleweek.abrastat.com) by 23:59 on Tuesday, May 26, 2026.
- Complete at least one puzzle to earn your Puzzle Week certificate. Complete them all for a Gold certificate!
- Answers will be revealed at the end of Puzzle Week.
- Have fun and good luck!



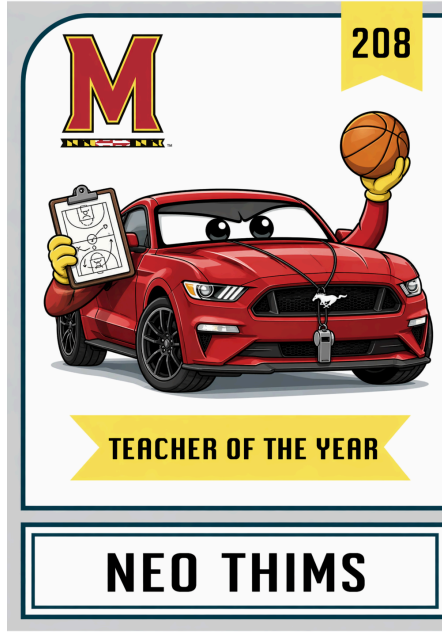
# Day 1: Trading Car[d]s

*Ugh I knew I shouldn't have bought trading cards off that sketchy website. Maybe if I put the room numbers all together they'll add up to something...*

1.



2.



3.



4.



5.



6.





7.



SILVER IN SLALOM

HOLTZ SNOHJ

8.



BRONZE IN TENNIS

EARL WITHERISH

9.



FBLA GOLD MEDAL

JIN MESS

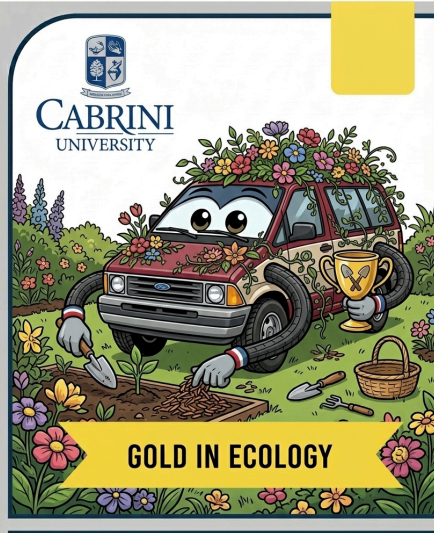
10.



GOLD IN FOOTBALL

TOLE I. FRIESEL

11.



GOLD IN ECOLOGY

JANE SNOW LEKKIO

ANSWER: \_ \_ \_ \_ \_



## Day 2: It's-a me, and my friends

*Each row and column EXCEPT for the last highlighted row and column contains exactly one of twenty related words. Letters are not always contiguous within a word. Each letter is used exactly once.*

|   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| W | A | M | L | I | U | B | I | G | B | I |
| D | E | R | M | L | A | O | R | K | I | O |
| A | T | O | W | O | F | A | B | O | O | D |
| I | K | S | A | U | M | B | E | O | W | K |
| L | A | A | A | K | Y | I | T | A | S | U |
| D | O | N | K | E | Y | K | O | O | N | G |
| B | M | L | R | I | O | O | I | R | D | O |
| Y | G | I | I | O | U | S | H | P | E | I |
| S | A | T | B | O | Z | W | S | E | R | R |
| P | D | N | E | G | Z | M | A | C | J | H |
| Y | D | A | O | I | Y | B | O | A | R | O |

ANSWER: \_ \_ \_ \_ \_

## Day 3: Connect Four

*I love the game Connections. Can I solve them all, and then put them together to find the final answer? **USE THE LINKS THE COMPLETE THE PUZZLE***

|        |          |           |         |
|--------|----------|-----------|---------|
| HARRY  | BEAST    | MARCIA    | HELENA  |
| FRANK  | BILLINGS | CINDY     | JAN     |
| SMOKEY | BIG SKY  | CHARMING  | BOZEMAN |
| JACKIE | WILLIAM  | SUGAR RAY | GREG    |

<https://tinyurl.com/Connections4A>

|          |            |           |          |
|----------|------------|-----------|----------|
| KORMA    | RED        | STADIUM   | THAI     |
| CHARCOAL | JET        | FOOTBALL  | FALCON   |
| OWL      | PENGUIN    | NEW YEARS | PASADENA |
| LICORICE | KINGFISHER | YELLOW    | ONYX     |

<https://tinyurl.com/Connections4B>

|            |           |          |            |
|------------|-----------|----------|------------|
| STABILITY  | PEACE     | JUVENILE | PROSPERITY |
| SATURDAY   | DEPILATED | HAIRLESS | JUNIOR     |
| ADOLESCENT | HARMONY   | REST     | BREAK      |
| SUNDAY     | YOUTHFUL  | SMOOTH   | SHAVEN     |

<https://tinyurl.com/Connections4C>

|         |           |          |          |
|---------|-----------|----------|----------|
| LEAD    | NEW       | DIAMONDS | WANING   |
| DEAD    | BERING    | WORK     | WAXING   |
| CASPIAN | NORTH     | STEER    | SOS      |
| GUIDE   | ACCOMPANY | FULL     | UMBRELLA |

<https://tinyurl.com/Connections4D>

|                       |
|-----------------------|
| ????????????s         |
| NBA ???s              |
| ????? ???? PERFORMERS |
| TYPES OF ??????       |

ANSWER: \_ \_ \_ \_ \_



# Day 4: Development Review Board

*These towns are planning where to put houses, can you help them fit exactly two into each row, column, and neighborhood? No two houses can be adjacent, either horizontally, vertically, or diagonally.*

|   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |  |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|--|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| W | T | H | O | A | N | Z | C | L |  | P | A | Q | T | I | S | D | W | H |
| R | E | W | N | L | I | P | S | N |  | M | O | A | L | P | C | R | H | C |
| A | G | H | T | Q | O | U | Y | H |  | H | B | G | A | F | S | X | Z | V |
| U | R | E | L | N | M | B | E | M |  | K | L | Y | H | C | L | X | E | B |
| R | M | Y | E | Q | L | K | G | F |  | N | D | T | O | A | I | N | S | P |
| N | Q | W | R | T | I | A | P | R |  | C | B | A | P | Y | G | S | H | B |
| W | M | Z | N | A | M | L | I | O |  | A | S | R | S | B | H | S | T | C |
| K | L | O | I | N | P | O | R | T |  | S | M | P | X | A | Y | N | O | A |
| E | M | I | B | M | X | C | E | U |  | P | A | A | U | I | R | L | W | L |

Coopertown

Manoa

ANSWER: \_ \_ \_ \_ \_

# Day 5: Find the Math Teachers

*You get the next letter*

|   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| A | P | Z | G | W | A | L | T | E | R | E | C | G | P | A |
| U | B | P | E | N | L | D | X | I | T | A | I | P | R | K |
| Z | R | L | Q | O | O | A | N | N | W | S | I | X | R | G |
| L | I | A | T | S | L | N | T | O | D | M | Z | W | E | F |
| U | E | S | G | K | A | I | N | W | S | X | C | P | L | E |
| M | U | K | K | C | V | S | H | A | J | R | N | X | S | Z |
| G | K | A | O | A | R | Z | M | A | G | J | E | P | I | K |
| Q | C | R | D | J | D | E | P | Q | D | I | D | T | U | E |
| X | A | I | T | R | A | W | E | T | S | I | E | G | E | M |
| G | N | S | A | H | E | S | O | D | M | L | R | F | H | P |
| S | R | S | Y | L | E | K | Z | X | A | R | I | X | M | F |
| Z | E | C | L | N | N | I | V | G | Y | L | L | E | K | L |
| U | P | S | O | U | B | T | T | M | Y | N | J | Z | H | C |
| B | O | J | R | T | N | A | I | L | A | K | A | B | O | D |
| N | P | L | E | D | W | A | R | D | S | D | L | H | E | I |

## Words to find:

- |                                                      |                                                   |
|------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| 1. Ursinus Grad and former soccer coach              | 12. Avid reader and Field Hockey Coach            |
| 2. Sings in a band and Widener free throw specialist | 13. Blue Hen and Coopertown parent                |
| 3. Mountain hiker and parent of colleague            | 14. New retiree and former tennis coach           |
| 4. Penn State grad and math leader                   | 15. Former Softball Coach and "Philly Winger"     |
| 5. Swim Coach and <u>nickname</u> Ball               | 16. Mother of 2 HHS grads and former HHS lax star |
| 6. Three daughters and Runner                        | 17. Haverford grad and rock climber               |
| 7. Doctor and Runner                                 | 18. Volleyball Coach and Girl Up leader           |
| 8. Doctor and Rucker                                 | 19. New Mom and West Chester Ram                  |
| 9. Served USA and Astronomer                         | 20. Choir singer and board game fan               |
| 10. Mother of 3 HHS grads and Peloton Legend         | 21. Former HMS Teacher and Rilo Kiley Fan         |
| 11. Family Feud Contestant and Marathoner            | 22. New Mom and former basketball coach           |
|                                                      | 23. Hooper and Temple Owl                         |

ANSWER: \_ \_ \_ \_ \_ \_ \_ \_ \_ \_

## Day 6: Mischief Managed

*A student working in the main office found this letter in the suggestion box and removed it before Mr. Donaghy saw it. The student wants to figure out who the tattletale is. Here is the letter:*

*Dear Mr. Donaghy,*

*I have information concerning planned mischief. Four students in four different Years are planning to carry out four different Pranks in four different Locations based on four different Motives.*

*Without revealing my own identity, I'm giving you the following clues which will be sufficient for you to catch them in the act and take appropriate disciplinary action.*

- 1. The student planning **Shenanigans** is not an upperclassman.*
- 2. **Abigail** is planning **Monkey Business**.*
- 3. The student who **Lost a Bet** is a **Senior** planning **Hijinks**.*
- 4. The Freshman is not motivated by a **Crush** or by having been **Picked Last**.*
- 5. The student in the **Library** is not motivated by having **Lost a Bet** or a **Dare**.*
- 6. The student with a **Crush** will not be found in the **Auditorium, Gym, or Library**.*
- 7. **Daisy** is not a **Sophomore** or a **Junior**.*
- 8. **Clive** is at least one year ahead of the student who was **Picked Last**.*
- 9. The student in the **Library** is at least one year ahead of the student in the **Science Lab**.*
- 10. **Brandon** is not planning **Horseplay**.*
- 11. The student in the **Gym** is not planning **Hijinks**.*
- 12. The student who **Lost a Bet** is at least one year ahead of **Daisy**.*

*Regards,*

*Anonymous*

*P.S. If there is any kind of reward for sharing this information, you can find out who I am once you have identified each Suspect's Motive, Location, Year, and Prank using the code number 1443133313552156.*

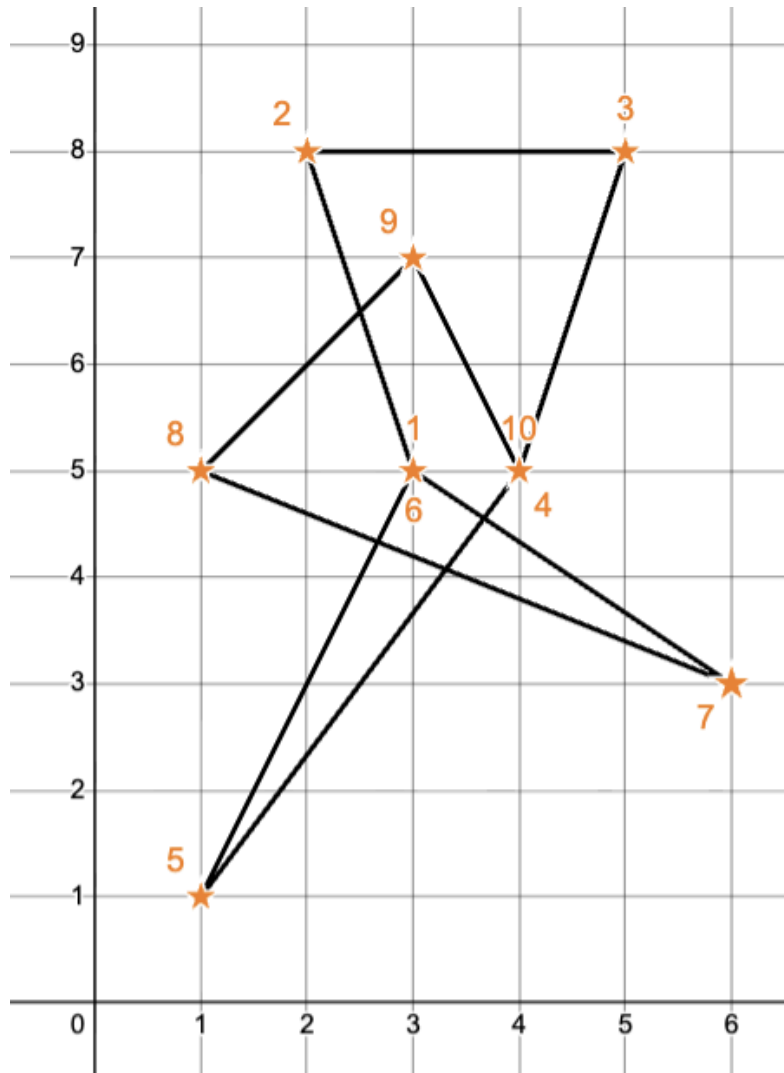
| Suspect | Motive | Location | Year | Prank |
|---------|--------|----------|------|-------|
| Abigail |        |          |      |       |
| Brandon |        |          |      |       |
| Clive   |        |          |      |       |
| Daisy   |        |          |      |       |

ANSWER: \_ \_ \_ \_ \_

|          |                 | Motive |  |  |  | Year |  |  |  | Location |  |  |  | Prank |  |  |  |
|----------|-----------------|--------|--|--|--|------|--|--|--|----------|--|--|--|-------|--|--|--|
| Suspect  | Abigail         |        |  |  |  |      |  |  |  |          |  |  |  |       |  |  |  |
|          | Brandon         |        |  |  |  |      |  |  |  |          |  |  |  |       |  |  |  |
|          | Clive           |        |  |  |  |      |  |  |  |          |  |  |  |       |  |  |  |
|          | Daisy           |        |  |  |  |      |  |  |  |          |  |  |  |       |  |  |  |
| Prank    | Hijinks         |        |  |  |  |      |  |  |  |          |  |  |  |       |  |  |  |
|          | Shananigans     |        |  |  |  |      |  |  |  |          |  |  |  |       |  |  |  |
|          | Horseplay       |        |  |  |  |      |  |  |  |          |  |  |  |       |  |  |  |
|          | Monkey Business |        |  |  |  |      |  |  |  |          |  |  |  |       |  |  |  |
| Location | Library         |        |  |  |  |      |  |  |  |          |  |  |  |       |  |  |  |
|          | Science Lab     |        |  |  |  |      |  |  |  |          |  |  |  |       |  |  |  |
|          | Auditorium      |        |  |  |  |      |  |  |  |          |  |  |  |       |  |  |  |
|          | Gym             |        |  |  |  |      |  |  |  |          |  |  |  |       |  |  |  |
| Year     | Freshman        |        |  |  |  |      |  |  |  |          |  |  |  |       |  |  |  |
|          | Sophomore       |        |  |  |  |      |  |  |  |          |  |  |  |       |  |  |  |
|          | Junior          |        |  |  |  |      |  |  |  |          |  |  |  |       |  |  |  |
|          | Senior          |        |  |  |  |      |  |  |  |          |  |  |  |       |  |  |  |

## MetaPuzzle: Graph of the (Day, ?)

*Instead of naming constellations by imagining connecting stars to form shapes, a student in Mr. Bilotti's class plots groups of stars as points on a graph and uses the points to name the constellation using the answers to the first six puzzles. It doesn't look like it at all, but this one is called \_ \_ \_ \_ \_.*



ANSWER: \_ \_ \_ \_ \_